

tional connected home solution, you need to integrate smart systems created by different vendors. This brings interoperability issues. However, some manufacturers are trying to bring down the differences and interoperability issues. For example, Z-Wave allows connected home manufacturers to integrate their devices with multiple smart home solutions.

But there are still many products that are not compatible with each other in one way or the other. That is, a Wi-Fi-enabled device cannot simply brew a cup of coffee of your choice unless you combine a coffee maker with WeMo and Google Assistant or Amazon Echo.

An AI-driven home automation system certainly offers peace of mind, convenience, home security and energy-efficiency. However, higher initial investment cost of the new technology causes a lot of hesitation to many consumers.

Another important aspect is security issues. Smart systems need to have a good firewall to prevent hacking, and to build a highly secure mechanism to guard against privacy and loss of sensitive information. But note that no security system is fool-proof. For example, facial recognition may work for now but may not work after twenty years, because your face may not be recognisable by then. Besides, it is not very accurate.

What a smart city is

The concept of the smart city lies in the use of technology to facilitate new experiences for its inhabitants to make living more comfortable and secure, among others. The definition of a smart city varies from city to city and country to country, depending on the requirements and aspirations of the city residents.

According to *forbes.com*, the top ten smart cities in the world are London, New York, Amsterdam, Paris, Reykjavik, Tokyo, Singapore, Copenhagen, Berlin and Vienna. These cities have been analysed across nine key points, including human capital, social cohesion, economy, environment, governance, urban planning, international outreach, technology, and mobility and transportation.

Smart city features include smart

urban planning, smart housings, creating walkable localities and reducing traffic congestion, reducing air pollution, preserving and developing open spaces (parks, playgrounds and recreational spaces), promoting a variety of transport options, making citizen-friendly location, providing adequate infrastructure and more.

AI in a smart city

AI and machine learning combined with the IoT have the potential to address many key challenges faced by the urban population, including water management, energy crisis, traffic management, healthcare and businesses.

Smart water management. When we shift from rural to urban cities, some of the important requirements are water, food, shelter and lights. Water and food are basic amenities for living beings. Technology helps us get our basic amenities and minimise the cost of living in cities. With AI, it is possible to streamline the use of water and power in a city. Smart grid technology can be employed to better manage the use of power and water metering to locate leaks and prevent excess use of water.

Smart lighting. Everybody wants streets to be properly lit. While street-lights are necessary, these consume a lot of energy. Use of smart lighting can certainly reduce consumption of energy by allowing lighting only those areas when needed.

Lamps can be used to adjust the brightness based on the presence of pedestrians, cyclists or cars. It is also possible to employ a real-time mesh network to trigger neighbouring lights and create a safe circle of lights around a human occupant.

Lamp posts with additional sensors can be employed for security applications or serve as Wi-Fi network hotspots. Thus, apart from smart grid metering, there are other smart ways to fully utilise energy in an optimised way.

Smart traffic management. Modern urban cities are crowded with vehicles. AI-based smart traffic solutions can be employed to ensure people moving from one point to another as safely and efficiently as possible. Some congested cities in



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